

Muhammad Farooqi — Kodiak HR Screen Prep

20 min call — Fall 2026 AI/ML Intern

Know These Company Facts Cold

- Founded 2018 by industry veterans in autonomous trucking
- 240+ person team with experience across AI, robotics, mobility, defense, and trucking
- First company to publicly deliver a driverless semi-truck to a customer (2024)
- 2.6 million+ autonomous miles driven, 7,000+ loads delivered
- Operating commercial freight routes daily across southern United States
- Also building autonomous capabilities for the US Department of Defense
- Backed by premier investors — positioned to scale with less capital than competitors
- Core product: Kodiak Driver — purpose-built virtual driver for Class 8 highway trucks
- Mission: become the trusted world leader in autonomous ground transportation

Four Core Values — Tie Your Answers Back to These

- Safety: Near 360 visibility, constant self-diagnosis, contingencies for the unexpected. The Kodiak Driver doesn't speed, get distracted, or drive drowsy.
 - Efficiency: Trucks drive nearly 24/7, stopping only to refuel and pick up loads. Cuts fuel consumption and emissions up to 25%.
 - Reliability: Built to operate in the most demanding and unpredictable conditions. Every minute matters.
 - Adaptability: Solutions integrate across industries, fit many vehicles, simple to maintain.
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Mock Interview Questions

Q1: Tell me about yourself.

- 3rd year Mechatronics + Robotics Engineering + AI option at Waterloo, 91% GPA
- Currently at Rivian — navigation software and CI/testing pipelines for ADAS and maps features
- Currently at WATOnomous — built a 3D voxel perception pipeline from scratch using PyTorch and ROS2
- Lincoln Electric — programmed 6-axis Fanuc and ABB welding robots in KAREL and RAPID
- AirMatrix — trained YOLOv8 vehicle detection model, built speed estimation pipeline
- Personal project: full SLAM robot with LiDAR, Raspberry Pi, Arduino, PS4 teleoperation

- Autonomous systems and robotics is what I want to build — Kodiak is exactly where I want to be

Q2: Why Kodiak specifically?

- Kodiak has actually deployed driverless trucks commercially — not a demo, a real product with 7,000+ loads delivered. That level of maturity is rare
- The mission aligns with me — safer roads, fewer of the 400,000+ annual truck accidents, better quality of life for drivers. Real-world impact
- The technical problem is genuinely hard — highway perception at speed, LiDAR + camera + radar fusion, edge cases at scale. That's the level I want to work at
- The DoD work signals the technology is robust enough for the most demanding environments — that's a high bar
- Kodiak's efficiency angle resonates — moving fast, staying focused, avoiding unnecessary complexity. That's how I work too
- The perception and ML work directly maps to what I've been building — voxel pipelines, sensor fusion, 3D understanding

Q3: You're at Rivian — how does that connect to Kodiak?

- Both are building reliable, safety-critical autonomous systems — that's the core overlap
- At Rivian I've built CI pipelines that catch navigation regressions before they reach production — same engineering discipline Kodiak needs for the Kodiak Driver
- ADAS features at Rivian — lane keep assist, driver display, rerouting — are a simpler version of what Kodiak does at highway scale
- Testing and validation infrastructure: writing end-to-end tests, catching failures early, validating system behavior — directly transferable
- Kodiak's reliability value — built for demanding conditions — is the same standard I hold my work to at Rivian

Q4: Why autonomous vehicles? Why not just software engineering?

- I want to build things that exist physically in the world with real consequences
- Software for a web app — if it breaks, someone gets an error. Software for an autonomous truck — if it breaks, someone gets hurt. That weight draws me in
- Kodiak's safety mission resonates deeply — 400,000+ truck accidents a year is a real problem. I want to work on technology that reduces that number
- Every project I've chosen reflects this — SLAM robot, voxel perception pipeline, welding robots, vehicle detection. All physical systems

- Kodiak is the most serious version of this problem — highway speeds, no safety driver, real freight.
That's where I want to be

Q5: What do you know about what Kodiak is working on?

- Autonomous long-haul trucking — running commercial freight routes daily across the southern US
- First company to publicly deliver a driverless semi-truck to a customer in 2024
- 2.6 million+ autonomous miles, 7,000+ loads delivered
- Core product is the Kodiak Driver — purpose-built virtual driver for Class 8 highway trucks, not adapted from passenger vehicle tech
- Expanding into US Department of Defense autonomous ground vehicle applications
- Four values driving the tech: Safety, Efficiency, Reliability, Adaptability
- Addressing real trucking industry problems — driver shortages, 400,000+ annual accidents, fuel inefficiency
- Claims up to 25% fuel reduction through consistent driving and reduced idling

Q6: What's your biggest weakness?

- Depth of ML research experience — my work has been applied: training models, building pipelines, deploying them
- Haven't spent time doing pure research — reading papers and pushing state of the art
- Actively closing that gap — reading papers on VoxelNet and PointPillars which are directly relevant to Kodiak's perception stack
- Kodiak is part of why I'm excited — I want to work closer to that research frontier and grow in that direction

Q7: Questions to ask them — always ask 2.

- What does the onboarding look like for interns — how quickly do you expect interns to be contributing to real systems?
- What's the biggest unsolved perception challenge the team is working on right now?
- How does the intern program connect interns to the broader team — is there cross-team exposure?

Quick Reference — Key Numbers to Drop

- 400,000+ truck-related accidents on US highways every year
- 2.6 million autonomous miles driven by Kodiak

- 7,000+ loads delivered commercially
- 240+ person team
- Founded 2018
- Up to 25% fuel reduction from autonomous driving
- First driverless semi-truck delivery to a customer: 2024
- Trucks drive nearly 24/7 — stopping only to refuel and pick up loads

■ *Keep answers concise — it's a 20 min call. Hit the bullet points, don't over-explain. Save technical depth for the technical rounds.*